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OSUN STATE UNIVERSITY, OSOGBO

NSG 407 — Past Questions & Materials

by Renance

Course: NSG 407

Institution: Osun State University, Osogbo

Papers in this pack: 1

Levels: 500

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Paper 1 of 1 — RESEARCH METHODOLOGY NSG 407 TOPIC: CONDUCTING LITERATURE REVIEW BY: MRS OYEKALE

Level 500 • First Semester • Handout

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

NSG 407

TOPIC: CONDUCTING LITERATURE REVIEW

BY: MRS OYEKALE

Conducting literature search/writing a good thesis

OUTLINE

- Definition
- Sources of literature
- Purpose of literature review
- Skills for conducting literature review
- Practical points to note
- Steps of the literature review
- Selecting material for review
- Practice session
- Guidelines for writing literature review
- Conclusion

WHAT IS LITERATURE REVIEW?

- Literature review is a critical explanation or description of scholarly publications on a topic of concern.
- A survey, scholarly articles, books and other sources (i.e. primary, secondary or tertiary) relevant to a particular issue, area of research or theory, providing a description, summary, and critical evaluation of each work
- “A research literature review is a systematic explicit and reproducible method for identifying, evaluating and synthesizing the existing body of completed recorded work produced by researchers, scholars and practitioners”, Featherstone (2011) citing (Fink, 2005)

WHAT IT IS NOT

- Not a list of published materials.
- Not a list summarizing one article after the other.

Sources of Literature

Primary sources:

- First hand reports of research found in academic journal articles, books of collected articles or Conference

papers and other original materials, such as historical documents, company reports, diaries or works of art or literature;

Secondary sources:

- These are critical evaluations and syntheses of original studies

Tertiary sources:

- These are information and idea often put together from secondary sources, e.g. text books that provide a broad overview of the topic

PURPOSE OF LITERATURE REVIEW

- Provides guide to a particular topic
- Gives an overview of the subject of concern
- Provides information about what is current
- Identifies opposing views
- Provides strong background for the research study
- Helps to identify methods that could be useful for the study.
- Ensures that researchers do not duplicate work that has already been done.

PURPOSE OF LITERATURE REVIEW

- Helps to put your work in perspectives
- Provides guideline for development or adaptation of instruments
- The scope (length and breath) of literature review helps readers to determine the credibility of researcher in his / her field.

REQUIRED SKILLS1

- Knowledge of use of indexes and abstracts.
- Ability to conduct exhaustive bibliographic searches.
- Ability to describe, critique and relate each source to subject area.
- Ability to organize collected data meaningfully
- Ability to present the organized review logically
- Ability to correctly cite all sources mentioned

PRACTICAL HINTS 1

Timing of literature review:

- May start before making decision on specific area of study.
- Is continuous throughout the duration of the study.

- Literature review must be guided by the objectives or research questions of the study.
- Indicate areas of controversy and agreements in the literature.
- Search results should be synthesized to a summary of what is and is not known.
- Finally there is need to formulate questions that need further research.

STEPS OF LITERATURE REVIEW

- Identify objectives /research questions for the study.
- Select source/sources for the search
- Choose search terms
- Run your search
- Apply practical screening criteria
- Apply methodological screening criteria
- Synthesize the results
- Write the literature review

IDENTIFY RESEARCH QUESTIONS

- Objectives of the study will guide the search
- The objective/ research questions will narrow down the topic
- Key word will be derived from the research questions
- Objectives will provide direction and precision

Selecting Materials for Review

- The researcher is advised to use three criteria for selecting material- relevance, authority and currency.
- The following questions may be asked for determining each criteria.

Relevance:

- Has the material contributed to the development of my main concepts?
- Does it clarify my position (either by supporting or contrasting it)?
- Does it provide key interpretations or models I can apply to my design?
- Is the material bound to a particular context or culture?

Selecting Materials for Review

Authority:

- Is the author qualified to report on the subject?
- Has it been published by a reputable source or can

you justify why it is an important source?

- Has the material been critically evaluated or assessed by other authors or colleagues; for example, peer reviewed or professionally edited.

Currency:

- Is the material still influential in the field?
- Is it up to date with new research?

SOURCES OF LITERATURE SEARCH

- Online publications bibliographic
- data base: PubMed Medline
- Private bibliographic data base:
- EMBASE (Biomedical database by Elsevier)
- Specialized Bibliographic data
- bases: Cochrane database for systematic review
- Manual/hand searches of Ref Lists
- Conference proceedings
- Websites : associations, organizations, HINARI
- Dissertation and theses, conference proceedings.

PRACTICAL SCREENING CRITERIA

- Date of publication (use toolbar)
- Category of participants by population for example, childbearing women, location (Nigeria, Africa)
- Publication language
- Research designs: used to identify broad range of potentially useful studies

GUIDELINE FOR WRITING THE LITERATURE REVIEW 1

- As you identify relevant literature , note source
- Make a reference list
- Read each paper through and through marking out area for specific subtheme,
- Mark out what is relevant for instrument development, methods or discussion of findings.
- Determine common theme, opposing themes, inconclusive opinions, trends, patterns, local, regional and global.

GUIDELINE FOR WRITING THE LITERATURE REVIEW 1

- Introduction, Body and Conclusion
- Introduction deals with background information

- Body/ structure is organized :
- Chronologically: time of event or publication time, or trends
- Thematic : themes / subtopics
- Methodological: focus is on methods of the researcher, types of intervention utilized and outcome measures

GUIDELINE FOR WRITING THE LITERATURE REVIEW 1

- Others: current information, questions raised from the review.
- Use evidence
- Be selective (select appropriate references)
- Avoid use of quotes except when necessary
- Summarize and synthesis within each paragraph and through the body of the work

GUIDELINE FOR WRITING THE LITERATURE REVIEW 1

- Start and end paragraph with your ideas and support with reports and other sources
- When you paraphrase ensure that meaning is retained not altered.
- Ensure you document all sources, using the acceptable referencing style
- Produce your first draft, Revise, Reread and Review
- Give others to read and effect corrections as necessary.
- Write a summary of the literature review
- Read again and again !!

Conclusion

- We have defined literature review, and discussed different aspects of this important aspect of thesis and dissertation writing.
- Hopefully this discuss has improved our perspective of literature review positively